

## Exercises 07

### Implementing Join: Nested-loop, Sort-merge, Hash

[\[Show with no answers\]](#) [\[Show with all answers\]](#)

1. Does the buffer replacement policy matter for sort-merge join? Explain your answer.

[\[show answer\]](#)

2. Suppose that the relation  $R$  (with 150 pages) consists of one attribute  $a$  and  $S$  (with 90 pages) also consists of one attribute  $a$ . Determine the optimal join method for processing the following query:

```
select * from R, S where R.a > S.a
```

Assume there are 10 buffer pages available to process the query and there are no indexes available. Assume also that the DBMS only has available the following join methods: nested-loop, block nested loop and sort-merge. Determine the number of page I/Os required by each method to work out which is the cheapest.

[\[show answer\]](#)

3. [Ramakrishnan, exercise 12.4] Consider the join  $Join_{[R.a=S.b]}(R, S)$  and the following information about the relations to be joined:

- Relation  $R$  contains 10,000 tuples and has 10 tuples per page
- Relation  $S$  contains 2,000 tuples and also has 10 tuples per page
- Attribute  $b$  of relation  $S$  is the primary key for  $S$
- Both of the relations are stored as simple heap files
- Neither relation has any indexes built on it
- There are 52 buffer pages available

Unless otherwise noted, compute all costs as number of page I/Os, except that the cost of writing out the result should be uniformly ignored (it's the same for all methods).

- a. What is the cost of joining  $R$  and  $S$  using page-oriented simple nested loops join? What is the minimum number of buffer pages required for this cost to remain unchanged?

[\[show answer\]](#)

- b. What is the cost of joining  $R$  and  $S$  using block nested loops join? What is the minimum number of buffer pages required for this cost to remain unchanged?



[\[show answer\]](#)

- c. What is the cost of joining  $R$  and  $S$  using sort-merge join? What is the minimum number of buffer pages required for this cost to remain unchanged?

[\[show answer\]](#)

- d. What is the cost of joining  $R$  and  $S$  using grace hash join? What is the minimum number of buffer pages required for this cost to remain unchanged?

[\[show answer\]](#)

- e. What would be the lowest possible I/O cost for joining  $R$  and  $S$  using *any* join algorithm? How much buffer space would be needed to achieve this cost?

[\[show answer\]](#)

- f. What is the maximum number of tuples that the join of  $R$  and  $S$  could produce, and how many pages would be required to store this result?

[\[show answer\]](#)

- g. How would your answers to the above questions change if you are told that  $R.a$  is a foreign key that refers to  $S.b$ ?

[\[show answer\]](#)

4. [Ramakrishnan, exercise 12.5] Consider the join of  $R$  and  $S$  described in the previous question:

- a. With 52 buffer pages, if *unclustered* B+ tree indexes existed on  $R.a$  and  $S.b$ , would either provide a cheaper alternative for performing the join (e.g. using index nested loop join) than a block nested loops join? Explain.

i. Would your answer change if only 5 buffer pages were available?

ii. Would your answer change if  $S$  contained only 10 tuples instead of 2,000 tuples?

[\[show answer\]](#)

- b. With 52 buffer pages, if *clustered* B+ tree indexes existed on  $R.a$  and  $S.b$ , would either provide a cheaper alternative for performing the join (e.g. using index nested loop join) than a block nested loops join? Explain.

i. Would your answer change if only 5 buffer pages were available?

ii. Would your answer change if  $S$  contained only 10 tuples instead of 2,000 tuples?

[\[show answer\]](#)

- c. If only 15 buffers were available, what would be the cost of sort-merge join? What would be the cost of hash join?

[\[show answer\]](#)

- d. If the size of  $S$  were increased to also be 10,000 tuples, but only 15 buffer pages were available, what would be the cost for sort-merge join? What would be the cost of hash join?

[\[show answer\]](#)

- e. If the size of  $S$  were increased to also be 10,000 tuples, and 52 buffer pages were available, what would be the cost for sort-merge join? What would be the cost of hash join?

[\[show answer\]](#)

5. Consider performing the join:

```
select * from R, S where R.x = S.y
```

where we have  $b_R = 1000$ ,  $b_S = 5000$  and where  $R$  is used as the outer relation.

Compute the page I/O cost of performing this join using *hybrid hash join*:

- a. if we have  $N=100$  memory buffers available

[\[show answer\]](#)

- b. if we have  $N=512$  memory buffers available

[\[show answer\]](#)

- c. if we have  $N=1024$  memory buffers available

[\[show answer\]](#)

